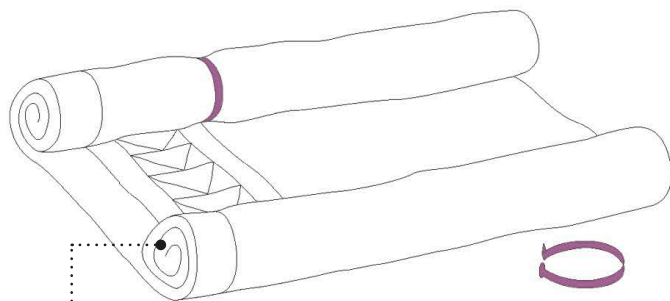


► MACHINE QUILTING BASICS

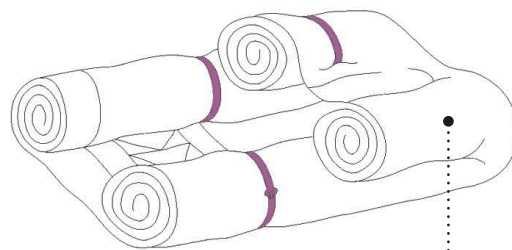
Beautifully machined quilts are in no way second best to those worked by hand. Because the stitches are continuous, the finished product is usually flatter than a hand-quilted one. An even-feed, or “walking”, foot,

which feeds the layers through at the same speed top and bottom, is useful. Start and finish either by setting the stitch length to 0 and taking a few stitches before resetting, or leave a tail of thread to tie off.

PREPARING A QUILT FOR MACHINING



1 To work on a small area at a time, roll up both sides of the quilt towards the centre, leaving 30cm (12in) open in between. Hold the edges with clips.

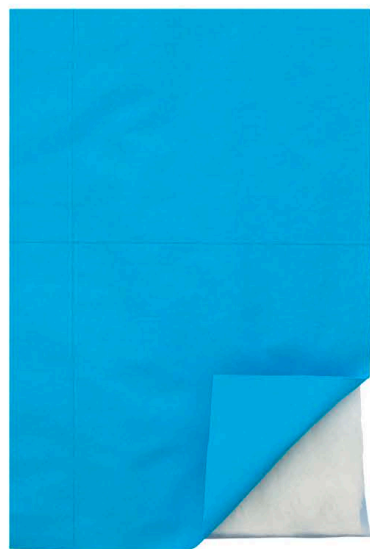


2 Fold or roll up the other ends of the piece and secure them using clips, leaving space to work on. Repeat the rolling and/or folding process as you work your way around the piece.

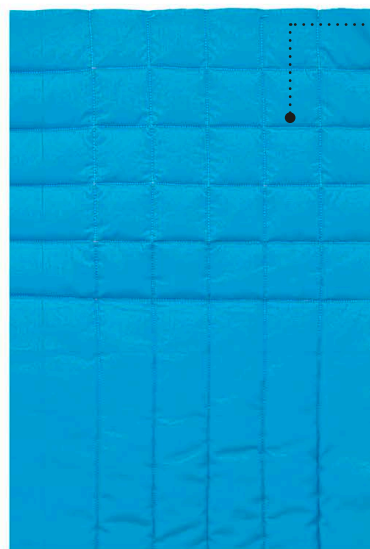
► GRID PATTERNS

Traditional gridded quilting patterns can be square or diamond shaped. Mark the grid by drawing the centre line in each direction, or use 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) masking tape.

If you set a quilting guide on your walking foot, you can use it to measure the distance between rows as you work.



1 Take a few short stitches. Set the quilting guide to the correct distance on one side and stitch the first marked row from edge to edge. Turn the work and use the quilting guide to measure each vertical row in turn.



2 Repeat to work the horizontal rows.